

nance factor evaluation.

While a recent promotion resets the performance factor evaluation, and a job transfer is internal mobility that may be a lateral job level, there are soft skills and technical skills that are most likely transferable. When assessing team members who have transferred teams or changed roles throughout the year, managers should gather feedback from the previous manager on performance as well and take that into account when evaluating and documenting performance to reflect performance for the entire year. Managers should also provide the team member feedback on how they're doing in their current role to ensure they're set up for success, and aware of feedback moving forward in their current position.

Best Practices for Communicating Performance/Growth Potential Factors

Communication

In most companies the Performance/Growth Potential Matrix is used exclusively as a management tool and results are not typically shared with team members. In the spirit of our transparency value, we want to encourage feedback with team members. Discussion topics that arise during calibration sessions (or at any other point during the assessment process) are confidential. Please do not share with anyone other than each individual team member.

After calibration sessions are done and performance and growth potential factors are determined, it's time to communicate the final results with team members. Please follow the Talent Assessment timeline and communicate performance and growth potential ratings to team members in your performance review conversations within the communication window. The conversation following the talent assessment process is the most important part; it is a great way to drive alignment with your team members and set them up for success moving forward. Below are some of the best practices for communications, but remember, if you are ever in doubt please reach out to your manager or People Business Partner for additional support.

1. Communicate performance and growth potential factors face-to-face over Zoom. As a manager, this is the opportunity for you to have a conversation with your team member about their performance and growth potential. Having the conversation over Zoom allows for you to have a dialogue with your team member (versus just sharing their performance and growth potential factor asynchronously) and allows you to pick up other information, like tone and non-verbal cues which can tell you more about how someone is feeling during this conversation. You may also choose to share the PDF of the review prior to the conversation so that your team member has time to process the information. If so, ideally share just 1-2 days prior to the conversation so you are able to address questions promptly.

1. Prepare for the discussion ahead of time. As a manager, you should prepare in advance of calibration discussions with your team members. Before communicating a team member's performance and growth potential factors, it's beneficial to look back through your preparation document, notes, and anything relevant that was discussed as part of the calibration exercise. Be prepared with notes on the following:

- Areas the team member is doing well
- Areas that need improvement
- Areas that you identified as either strengths and/or development areas that differed from the team member's self-assessment.
- Provide specific examples for both strengths and improvement areas. The SBI (Situation - Behavior - Impact) model can be effective for delivering examples structured in a way that

makes impact clear to team members.

- Think about recommendations and/or focus areas for a team member's development OR if a team member has an active Individual Growth Plan(IGP), consider how the feedback fits into their current IGP

1. Schedule a separate call or repurpose your 1:1) to discuss a team member's performance and growth potential factor. The performance and growth potential factors should be communicated at the beginning of the meeting. This allows the team member time to ask questions, discuss their assessment, and most importantly, determine next steps. If your 1:1s are often filled with agenda items, the recommendation is to schedule another call to make sure you have ample time allocated.

1. Protect the confidentiality of other team members by avoiding saying things like "you were the only team member to be rated this performance factor."

1. Avoid making future promises like, "In the next review, I will rate you X performance/growth potential factor."

Sample Script for Delivering a Talent Assessment

The script below is intended to help you structure your Performance and Growth Potential conversation. Personalizing this conversation to reflect your authentic tone will make this a more effective conversation with your team member.

"Thank you for taking some time today to discuss your Performance and Growth Potential. I wanted to discuss your achievements and strengths, improvement areas, future development, and the final result of the talent assessment."

"I assessed your performance factor as [Insert Performance factor]:"

- Exceeding (consistently surpassing the demands of their current position)
- Performing ("on track" and meeting all expectations of current position)
- Developing (room to learn and grow, not currently meeting all expectations of current position)
- Too New To Rate (hired or transferred <90 days from the start of the Talent Assessment program)

"I assessed your performance as [Insert Performance Factor] because:"

- I assessed your performance against your job responsibilities as [Insert Performance Factor].
 - Your strengths in your job responsibilities are [Insert strengths with supporting examples]
 - Your opportunities in your job responsibilities are [Insert opportunities with supporting examples]
- I assessed your performance against values competencies as [Insert Performance Factor].
 - Your strengths in aligned competencies are [Insert strengths with supporting examples]
 - Your opportunities in aligned competencies are [Insert opportunities with supporting examples]

"I assessed your growth potential factor as [Insert Growth potential factor]:"

- Exceeding (ready to take on more responsibilities within the next year (or when an opportunity arises))
- Growing (growing in current role, demonstrating interest in advancing (up or laterally) and

they exhibit knowledge, skills, and abilities that indicate this.)

- Developing (not working at full growth potential against the roles and responsibilities)

"I assessed your growth potential as [Insert Growth Potential Factor] because:"

- I assessed your growth potential against the four pillars of growth potential as [Insert Growth Potential Factor].

- You have shown X, Y, Z [Insert strengths with supporting examples]
- Your opportunities to further grow in your role are X, Y, Z are [Insert opportunities with supporting examples]

If a team member was identified as key talent, please ensure to communicate to the team member during the talent assessment conversation.

I'd like to thank you for your hard work as, and I look forward to continuing to work together!

Do you have any questions? [Allow team member to ask questions and respond]

As a next step, let's schedule some time to talk more about what you want to do in the future and create a career development plan together OR let's talk about how this feedback should be incorporated into your Individual Growth Plan.

Sample Next Steps

The most important part of the talent assessment discussion is to determine next steps in partnership with your team member. The team member should be the DRI for the next steps with support from you as their manager. Our Career Development handbook page includes a lot of great information and resources on career development including an Individual Growth Plan guide which should help provide structure and a plan for next steps.

If you have any questions or concerns about next steps, please contact your manager and/or your People Business Partner.

Information Guide

Performance/Growth Potential Review General Information

- Why does this matter to me?

The Talent Assessment involves all team members and managers.

- Team Members are assessed according to performance and growth potential. Team Members should be prepared to have a conversation with their manager about their performance and growth potential in Q1 each year.

- Managers assess their team members' performance and growth potential. Managers attend calibration meetings in which team members' ratings are discussed and evaluated to ensure consistency and minimize bias. Once the program closes, managers are responsible for communicating Performance/Growth Potential Factor to team members.

- Can I use Claude or other AI tools to help me with my self evaluation?

- Yes. You may use Claude, Insights, and GitLab Wrapped to assist in the preparation of your self evaluation. AI tools like these can be super helpful to assist you in gathering information about your accomplishments, or helping you brainstorm how you might refine your

self evaluation. However, meaningful human input and review is always required, and you should not rely solely on Claude to write your self-evaluation.

- Can I utilize Claude or other AI tools to help with manager evaluations?
- Claude is the only AI tool you are permitted to use for this purpose, and it may only be used to assist in the writing of manager evaluations. Use of Insights, GitLab Wrapped, or any other AI tool for the assessment of team members or the writing of manager evaluations is not permitted. Claude can be super helpful to assist you in brainstorming how you might refine the feedback in your manager evaluation. However, meaningful human input is required in assessing performance and growth potential of your team members, and you should not rely solely on Claude to write manager evaluations. We also have a robust calibration process in our talent assessment program to ensure we are consistently and fairly assessing performance and growth potential across GitLab.
- How does this impact the way I work at GitLab?
 - The Performance Assessment is an evaluation of your performance against job family responsibilities and GitLab competencies and Growth is evaluated against the 4 pillars of Growth Potential. Both can help you determine strengths and improvement areas that you can apply in your day-to-day work/way you work.
- How does this impact the teams I lead?
 - As a manager, you assess your team members' performance and growth potential. Managers attend calibration meetings in which team members' assessments are discussed and evaluated to ensure consistency and minimise bias. Once the program closes, managers are responsible for communicating Performance/Growth Potential Factor to team members.
- Who can I reach out to in supporting me during Talent Assessments for my team?
 - You can reach out to your manager or your aligned People Business Partner.
- As a manager, when reviewing my team members, what is the difference between Developing and Underperformance?
 - The "Developing" rating means that the team member is not (yet) meeting all of the responsibilities and competencies for the role. This can be for many reasons, including a recent start date. By contrast, Underperformance involves consistently not meeting the goals and requirements of the job; GitLab follows specific processes to attempt to remediate.
 - While everyone within the Developing category isn't automatically Underperforming, a team member who is Underperforming would also be grouped into the Developing category, because Performing is not an accurate assessment.
 - Team members who are on a formal Underperformance remediation plan, such as a Performance Improvement Plan, are not eligible for a compensation increase as a result of the Annual Compensation Review.
- Will my Growth Potential assessment impact my compensation?
 - Yes both Performance, Growth Potential, and Key Talent Assessment can impact your Total Rewards.
- Can my performance factor be changed?
 - After the Talent Assessment closes, the performance factor cannot be changed. You should work with your manager to develop a plan to develop your performance for future assessments.

- Does this mean I am automatically getting an X% increase in the upcoming Annual Compensation Review?

The Performance/Growth Potential Factor is one of the factors considered in the Annual Compensation review. The recommended increases displayed in the handbook are there to ensure company wide consistency. The factors taken into account for the Annual Compensation Review are:

- Your hire date (new hires hired after October 31st are ineligible for compensation review)
- Other compensation increases received over the last year
- Timing of promotion and/or role changes
- Your current placement within the compensation band
- Location factor
- Role benchmark updates
- Company budget for compensation increases

- When is the next opportunity for my performance to be reviewed?

- Talent Assessments are formally conducted at the beginning of the fiscal year (Q1) to assess the prior year, and we encourage a mid-year check-in at the half-year.

- What can I do to change my performance factor in the future?

- There are many things that you can do to change your performance factor in the future.

Please work with your manager on a career development plan and discuss actions that can be taken to improve.

- Can my Growth Potential rating be changed?

- After the Talent Assessment closes, your growth potential factor cannot be changed. Your manager assessed your growth potential factor and this would be an opportunity for you and your manager to align on your growth opportunities. This discussion can also be an input into your career development discussion.

- What can I do to change my Growth Potential rating in the future?

- There are many things that a team member can do to change their growth potential factor in the future. Talk with your manager about how you might be able to develop a plan to increase your expandability, adaptability, consistency and self-awareness. Do you currently possess all the skills needed for your current role? Have you identified what skills you would like to learn? Have you determined what your career goals are, and are you actively working towards those goals? Are there additional projects to take on, to stretch your current responsibilities and/or skills? These are some discussion questions that might help you and your manager align on a future plan for growth.

- My team member is currently on a performance remediation plan; how should I handle this?

- You should continue to move forward with communicating their performance factor to them and use the meeting as an opportunity to reinforce the expectations of meeting the goals highlighted in the plan.

Talent Assessment - Manager Scenarios

My team member is on a leave (protected leave or PTO) during the Talent Assessment period. How should I handle communication of their assessment?

If they will be returning from leave before the due date to communicate Talent Assessment

results, please wait until their return from leave to communicate their assessment. If they are returning from leave after the due date to communicate Talent Assessment results, you may email them to offer to discuss their assessment. If they do not reply or prefer to wait until their return, please respect that choice.

My team member was on protected leave for a large portion of the Talent Assessment period. How should I factor this in when assessing them?

It's important to ensure you are assessing the team member's performance for their contributions while working during the assessment time period. There should be no adverse impact on their overall assessment due to being on leave for a portion of the period. During calibration, please remain vigilant to ensure no private details related to their time away are disclosed. Please reach out to your PBP to discuss the specific details related to your team member.

My team member is on leave of absence during the Talent Assessment communication window. What happens to their Talent Assessment?

Please do not action the To-Do task "Meet with your Employee" if your team member is on leave of absence (LOA). We will exclude team members on LOA from the auto advancement setting on TBD and you can communicate their talent assessment when they return to work.

My team member was assessed as key talent last year, and is not for this assessment period. How should I handle communication with them?

There is no guarantee that team members will retain their key talent assessment each assessment period. Make sure to explain the reasons why their key talent assessment has changed, including how we assess Key Talent and the definition outlined in the Handbook.

Remember to end the conversation by discussing what your expectations are of key talent going forward. It's important not to make promises about future assessments, but to focus on what makes a team member critical to the business, and how you, their manager, will support them.

My team member was exceeding performance last assessment, and is not for this period. How should I communicate this change?

It's important to take a look at what may have changed since last year. Is your team member in a new role? On a new team? Did they take on bigger stretch assignments?

Any of these factors can influence a team member's performance. Be prepared with specific examples to share which support your performance assessment. The feedback conversation should also focus on what success looks like for the team member in the year to come and how you, as the manager, can support them with their goals.

I have just adopted a new team, and the previous manager is no longer at GitLab. How can I assess the performance of my team fairly?

You may be able to gather insights from your manager or cross functional stakeholders who have worked closely with the team member in the performance period. You may have access to the recent 360 feedback for each of your team members, as well as their talent assessment from last year to help inform your thinking. If you haven't already, it's important to ask the team member to share their own perspective on their accomplishments prior to you taking the role, so

you are well prepared for the discussion of your assessment.

A team member recently moved to be my direct report, however for the majority of the performance year, they reported to another manager. Are there options to delegate or re-assign the manager evaluation to their previous manager?

As a manager, you can delegate the manager evaluation to another manager in your direct management chain. If your team member moved from another manager in another organization, you should collaborate with the previous manager to write the review with their input. The previous manager can leverage the Talent Assessment google template to capture their feedback and provide it back to you so that you can enter it into Workday. As the new manager, you will be responsible for the calibration of team members in your management chain at the time of calibration. You should also ensure your communication of the final talent assessment is done in a joint conversation with the previous manager, you as the new manager and your team member.

This would be a great opportunity to ensure a formal transition and knowledge of performance and feedback takes place between previous manager and new manager. Please enter a HelpLab request if you have any questions about your specific scenario.

My team member does not agree with their placement in performance and growth potential. How should I approach this?

Remember that this conversation will be most effective if you are well prepared. If you haven't yet, take an opportunity before the performance and growth potential conversation to understand their own assessment of their results.

During the performance and growth potential conversation, provide the opportunity for a dialogue with your team member. Remain open and curious about their perspective. Engage in active listening, ensuring that you aren't planning your counterpoints while they are sharing.

The expectation is not that the results will necessarily change but the insights they provide may shape how you both think about their growth and development path.

If you feel a conversation might be particularly challenging, you may reach out to the TMR team or your PBP to role play the discussion and ensure you are prepared.

My team member is exceeding growth potential expectations, how should I be thinking about their ongoing development?

Great! At GitLab team members have the opportunity to own their own development, and deserve a great manager (you) to facilitate it. Ask your team member to articulate where they would like to see their skills and career develop. You may have insights that help them refine those goals based on where you see the business going, as they will be most successful in gaining the experience they're looking for if there are opportunities to align those goals with business goals.

The Career Development handbook page has more ideas to help your team member craft a growth plan, including information on GitLab's Growth and Development benefit.

How should we be communicating Growth Potential to team members?

First, ensure the team member understands what we mean when we say we are assessing Growth Potential, including the 4 pillars that you considered when making the assessment. Be prepared

with specifics that led to your evaluation.

Remember, Growth Potential can change over time as team members are promoted, develop new interests, as new opportunities for growth arise, and as team members continue to broaden their knowledge, skills, and abilities. Avoid making promises, but if your team member sees themselves in a higher position, help them understand behaviors you expect to be able to assess them differently next time.

I received unexpected feedback about my team member from a cross-functional stakeholder in my calibration session. What should I do?

If you receive unexpected feedback during the calibration, ensure you really understand what happened, and what has been discussed with your team member so far. If someone has tried to help this team member in the past, how did it go? Can your peer provide specifics to help you understand the impact of the behaviors? Talk to your peer about the importance of using this feedback to help your team member grow, and make sure you have agreement on how you plan to deliver this message.

During the discussion with your team member, be prepared to gain their perspective on the situation first. Listen actively and consider their point of view. When delivering the message, consider the root cause, focus on impact and alignment with our values, and end with a discussion on future actions that would be more successful.

If and when appropriate, check in with your peer on how improvements are going. Be sure to stay close to the situation so you are in a position to deliver more timely feedback if the behavior is ongoing.

How do I assess team members in acting or interim roles?

For team members who have assumed an Acting or an Interim role, we will assess team members aligned with their permanent positions (i.e. not the Acting or Interim position).

As the Talent Assessment impacts compensation, and Acting/Interim periods are not permanent, in the instance that a team member does not end up moving into the Acting/Interim role permanently, we would not want to have their compensation impacted by a temporary position.

My team member is performing at a high level in terms of results, but they struggle with behavioral alignment to one or more of our values. How do I take the "how" into account when I am assessing their performance and growth?

Review the handbook content on how we measure Performance and how we measure Growth Potential. When a high output/results-oriented team member is struggling with soft skills and/or behavior, this is oftentimes related to improvement areas in terms of alignment to our values competencies, and/or our Growth Potential pillars (particularly, but not limited to, Self-Awareness). Considering our measurement guidelines for Performance and Growth Potential holistically, and be sure that your assessment takes all of our competencies, job family responsibilities, and pillars into account.

My team member has the skills to perform, but there are will-based performance issues that are impacting their ability or the team's ability to succeed. How should I think about this in terms of assessing their performance?

First, act early. Do not wait for a formal performance and growth potential assessment conversation to deliver feedback about your concerns. Be specific, and document your

conversation. Loop in a TMR specialist for support as these conversations can be challenging.

Review the definition of "Developing" performance. Note that one criteria that applies to this category is a team member who is struggling to perform in a way that is aligned to our values and competencies. Think about the specific behaviors or impacts of their work or how they are working that have led you to assess that they are not fully engaged. Despite having the skills, if your team member is not contributing at the level they are expected to be, you should consider that a performance issue in the way you would a skill based performance issue. Keep in mind that not addressing these challenges may be affecting your other team members, especially those who may be picking up the slack. We encourage to review the handbook page on Underperformance.

Mid-Year Check In

Great managers share feedback with team members year-round in 1:1 meetings and ad-hoc. A dedicated Mid-Year check-in is a useful tool to support a holistic discussion between team member and manager about how things are going as we approach the second half of the fiscal year. During the Mid-Year check in, we assess how things are going from both the team member and managers' points of view, and share feedback to help inform performance and development plans. Leaning into where things are going well, as well as uncovering blind spots or improvement areas early are the keys to delivering great results. A Mid-Year check in complements weekly, on-going feedback, so we recommend documenting your discussion in your 1:1 doc to support frequent updates on action items and development goals.

Goals of the Mid-Year check in are:

- To provide a dedicated space for questions/clarification about performance and growth opportunities at GitLab
- Team members share a cumulative self assessment of their performance against expectations and progress on development goals
- Managers respond, and provide their own cumulative update to the team member on how things are going. This should build on the regular performance feedback they should be delivering weekly in 1:1s and ensure no surprises at the end of the year review.

Eligibility

To participate in the mid-year check in we recommend that team members have at least 3 months of tenure so accomplishments and improvement areas are able to be clearly outlined with examples.

Process

Recommended process for our Mid Year check-in will be as follows:

1. Team Member Led: Team member provides a self-assessment on their own performance in their 1:1 document

A Google docs template is available to guide the self-assessment process. Team members are encouraged to author a document based on this template, share it with their manager and link it to the top of their 1:1 document. Team members should reflect on their achievements, strengths,

and opportunity areas since the last formal Talent Assessment in Q4. It is the team member's responsibility to provide the self-assessment and bring it to the conversation with their manager to discuss and align on. Linking the document to the 1:1 agenda ensures the self-assessment is available to come back to throughout the rest of the year.

The template contains an agenda for the Mid-Year check-in as follows:

- Achievements

List your 3 most significant achievements since the last formal Talent Assessment, aligned with the job responsibilities and expectations of the role. This can include significant impact to the department or company, customer-impact, community-impacting, etc. Feedback can also be included in this section if applicable.

- Strengths & Opportunities in Role

In this area the goal is to determine 2-3 strengths and 2-3 opportunity areas in accordance with your role, job family, and job framework. Include examples when necessary to provide clarity or context. Ensure there are actionable takeaways.

- Support Needed

A place to outline any support needed from your manager for your ongoing success and development at GitLab.

- Manager Feedback

Managers will provide additional feedback or response to the self-assessment outlined above. Managers should be sure to reference the Achievements (3) and Roles & Responsibilities (Strengths and Opportunities) outlined by the team member above, and to any additional thoughts or feedback (2-3 points).

- Next Steps

A space for the team member and manager to document any relevant next steps stemming from this conversation. This could be a full Individual Growth Plan or a couple of key actions or development opportunities for the individual.

1. Manager Feedback: Team members let their manager know when they have provided their self-assessment overview in their 1:1 document

Team members should share their Mid-Year Check In document with their manager at least one week prior to the live discussion to ensure managers have time to review the content, and to add in their own feedback in the Manager Feedback section.

1. Live Discussion

Team members and managers use a dedicated 1:1 to discuss the Mid Year check in.

1. Align on actions/next steps

Team member and manager align on action items stemming from the conversation to best support team member development and alignment to their goals. You are encouraged to leverage our Career Development and Mobility) handbook page for ideas and inspiration.

Timeline

Mid-Year Check-In Timeline (FY2026):

- 2025-06-16 · 2025-06-30: Manager & Team Member preparation & 360 feedback gathering (optional)
- w/c 2025-06-30 & 2025-07-07: People Manager Enablement Sessions
- 2025-07-01 · 2025-07-18: Mid-year conversations conducted & documented
- 2025-07-21 · 2025-07-25: Follow-up on development & performance goals

Succession Planning

Succession planning is an important step in our Talent Assessment process. Completing the Performance/Growth Potential Assessment gives leaders a fresh overview of the top performers and the highest growth team members in their respective organizations. Particularly for individuals in Senior Leadership roles and above (the S-Group and depending on structure the Director-Group, a recommended next step following the Performance/Growth Potential assessment is to do succession planning.

Succession planning ensures we are identifying and developing future GitLab leaders to ensure business continuity in the event of an unforeseen change, and providing the current leadership team the opportunity to grow and scale. It may provide an opportunity to diversify our leadership team by developing our internal bench of talent. Note, potential alone does not determine who will be a successor. Strong succession candidates should demonstrate sustained exceeding performance and growth, aspire to have a role at the next level, and be ready for a much larger role in the near term.

Questions we should ask ourselves when thinking about succession planning (and the individual(s) identified) are:

1. What are our current and upcoming business goals?
1. Does the successor candidate have a track record of delivering strategic results, working in alignment with our values, and demonstrating high growth potential?
1. Does our successor candidate have skill gaps that must close before they are ready to deliver on the business goals identified?
1. (if we do have skill gaps) Can we develop our successors to close those gaps? If so, how? How long will this additional exposure and skill development take? Who else at GitLab should we engage to support their development?
1. If not, do we need to hire externally to ensure business continuity?
1. If we do not have anyone who could assume the role in an emergency situation, what is our plan to provide emergency coverage?

Succession Planning Process

The succession planning process might vary slightly for different areas of the business depending on size and structure, but at a high level the process should flow as follows:

1. Leaders go through the Performance/Growth Potential Assessment process for all of their direct reports. Ideally, this process includes calibration to generate a level of initial familiarity amongst leadership peers with the talent in the organization.
1. Leaders identify and document their respective successors (and emergency coverage plans if the identified successor could not currently cover in an emergency situation) leveraging this template.
1. Succession plans are reviewed with peers (i.e. all other executives, all other senior leaders in the function, etc.) and your People Business Partner, ideally during a synchronous session to facilitate discussion and questions.
1. Development plans are finalized for successors and documented in the successor slide.
1. (if applicable) Skills gaps impacting ability to achieve business goals are identified and actions are put in place to ensure these gaps are closed/minimized (i.e. stretch assignments, increased visibility and exposure, or hiring)

Succession Readiness Definitions

Succession Readiness	Description
Emergency (ER)	Someone who could take over this role if the current person were affected by a lottery factor or had to take emergency leave. Has competency and experience to provide coverage on an interim basis (~6 months), but may not be suitable for the role long-term Note: If there is no one who could assume the role today in an emergency situation, part of the succession coverage plan should include an overview of recommendation steps (i.e. engaging a consultancy, splitting up the team, etc.)
Ready Now (RN)	Someone who has 90% of the competency & experience to take the role now
Ready in 1-2 years	With additional responsibility & exposure, could take the role soon. Likely has the competency and experience to provide coverage on an interim basis if there is an urgent business need
Ready in 2-3+ years	Longer term candidate who requires significant development. May also have the competency to provide coverage on an interim basis if there is an urgent business need.

Note that the Emergency Coverage slide in the template above should only be used to if the identified successor could not provide temporary coverage for the current leader in an emergency situation.

Resources

Resource	Purpose
Workday: Self Assessment & Manager Evaluation Template	Team members and managers can leverage this template to begin thinking through and documenting the optional self-assessment and the manager evaluation for the Talent Assessment. Please note that this template is for team members who would like to get an early start ahead of Workday launching the Talent Assessment cycle, however, all assessments will need to be transferred over to Workday for formal documentation and calibration.
Workday Job Aid: How to Complete My Annual Self Evaluation	Team member instructions for how to complete their annual Self-Evaluation task in Workday.
Workday Job Aid: How to Complete the Manager Evaluation and Assess Growth Potential	Manager instructions for how to complete their Manager Evaluation task and Assess Growth

Potential task in Workday. |

| Workday Job Aid: How to Complete Talent Calibration | Manager instructions for how to complete their Talent Calibration in Workday. |

| Workday Job Aid: How to Facilitate Calibration - PBPs | PBP instructions for how to facilitate calibration sessions in Workday. |

| Workday Calibration Video Tutorial | Manager instructions for how to complete their Talent Calibration in Workday. |

| Talent Assessment Calibration Agenda Doc | This template can be used by managers to ensure similar pre-work, structure, and context to generate alignment ahead of live calibration sessions. The agenda is also recommend to ensure rationale behind potential assessment changes during calibration are recorded. |

| Values competencies | Values competencies form an important part of the Performance Factor evaluation and are important to review prior to beginning the assessment period. |

|High Performing Team Indicators | We've broken down each characteristic of high performance to help you recognize and measure success. |

|Remote work competencies | Remote work competencies form an important part of the Performance Factor evaluation and are important to review prior to beginning the assessment period. |

| Functional competencies | Functional competencies (for groups that have them developed) can also influence the Performance Factor and should be reviewed prior to the assessment period. |

| | It is important to me mindful of unconscious bias always, and especially during talent reviews and assessments. It is highly recommended that you review the handbook page and watch the training. |

| Performance Factor handbook page | This page is the SSOT to review the Performance Factor's impact on compensation. |

Key Talent

Key Talent Criteria

Key Talent makes up roughly ~10% of the population. Key Talent represents team members who have a significant impact on GitLab's present and future success. They deliver quality results that are instrumental in moving critical company initiatives forward and do so consistently in alignment with our values. These team members are often recognized as experts in their current role. Team members, at any level, can be considered Key Talent.

Team members identified as Key Talent typically have knowledge, skills, and experience that:

- Substantially impacts the company's ability to achieve significant milestones and results
- Demonstrates consistently strong performance
- Demonstrates growth potential; the ability and desire to assume increasingly more broad or complex responsibilities and learn new skills.
- Has an outsized, measurable impact on business performance
- Has a significant impact to the operation of a critical functional area
- Has demonstrated the ability to scale with the organization

Key Talent, Performance, and Growth Potential

Team members identified as key talent must be assessed at minimum Performing and Growing (Box 4) in the Talent Assessment process.

Although Performance and Growth Potential are a consideration in the Key Talent selection process, they are not the only criteria used to determine the designation and should not be used in isolation. It is important to look holistically at the Key Talent Criteria outlined above when determining who qualifies as Key Talent on your team.

"TNTR" (Too New to Rate) team members can be considered key talent but this would be an exception. In order for a "TNTR" team member to be identified as key talent they must meet the criteria above and be ramping successfully in their new role.

We exclude team members rated "TNTR" when we calculate our Key Talent distribution across the company. E.g. Team members designated Key Talent during Calibration divided by Talent Assessment eligible team members (excluding TNTR) = Key Talent Distribution %

Below are a few examples to help managers think through Key Talent designations as they relate to Performance and Growth Potential:

1. A team member that has a performance assessment of "Exceeding" is not automatically identified as Key Talent. Perhaps they are doing exceptionally well in their role, but the impact on business performance may not be significant enough to meet the definition above.
1. A team member that is new to the role due to recent promotion and rated "TNTR" could be identified as Key Talent if they are ramping successfully in their role and have a high impact on the ability for the company to achieve results.

Note: Intentionally hoarding knowledge is in direct conflict with our transparency value and is viewed as a performance issue as we measure performance based on alignment with our values.

Key Talent and Single Points of Failure (SPOF)

Single Points of Failure (SPOF) refers to a single person whose absence would significantly impact the ability of an area of the company to function.

Team members that are identified as Key Talent can also be SPOF, as the definition of SPOF overlaps with a few of the Key Talent Criteria outlined above, however, a team member who is identified as SPOF is not also Key Talent by default.

A few key differences between Key Talent and SPOF include: team member's performance and growth potential, risk mitigation plans, and support/development strategies.

Four scenarios exist in the context of our Talent Assessment:

- Team member identified as Key Talent
- Team member identified as SPOF
- Team member identified as Key Talent and SPOF
- Team member identified as neither one

To review the SPOF definition in more detail along with a few examples, please review our Organizational Design handbook page.

Process To Determine Key Talent

It is important to have a holistic view of all team members when determining who meets the key talent criteria, which is why we require a certain scope when calibrating key talent and making final recommendations in the organization. There are several factors that can help determine the level at which key talent should be assessed, including things like reporting lines and span of control. As a general rule, if a people manager meets the following requirements, key talent calibrations should start at their level:

- Senior Manager level or above
- 20+ direct and indirect reports

The process to determine Key Talent is as follows:

1. Direct managers make initial key talent recommendations in Workday. The direct manager should include the key talent recommendation along with the Performance and Growth Potential recommendation. The key talent criteria that is met should be noted in Workday.
1. During sub-department calibration sessions, Senior Managers+ should calibrate on the initial key talent recommendations and make adjustments as appropriate, keeping in mind both key talent criteria, and number of individuals identified as key talent, as key talent makes up only ~10% of team members company-wide.
1. The Senior Manager (if applicable), Director, Senior Directors, VP, and People Business Partner (PBP) discuss and calibrate the Key Talent nominations at the department level calibration sessions.
1. A final proposal goes to the E-Group member who adds in their Key Talent and reviews for final approval on Division level.

Organizational Value

A very small portion of our business (roughly ~10% of the population) is considered to be key talent. As such, a team members' value in the organization should not be determined based on whether or not they are identified as key talent.

While some team members are identified as key talent, this does not mean the rest of our team is not valued and important to our organization's success. Aligned with our expected performance distribution, approximately 60-65% of our team are core performers (or "performing"). Core performers are responsible for keeping things consistently moving forward. This group comprises the largest population in companies across the board for a reason and is an essential part of any organization's success.

Impact of Being Identified as Key Talent

We want to make sure we use engagement tools to retain Key Talent. A few of our primary engagement tools are: Learning & Development, growth opportunities and compensation.

- Learning & Development: We want to support the growth of Key Talent and their competencies, skills, and knowledge by providing them with the tools they need and the opportunities to progress their own personal and professional development goals. As a people manager it's your priority to identify L&D opportunities for your team.
- Growth Opportunities: As a people manager, it's important to have career conversations and identify growth opportunities with your team members. For Key Talent, it's especially important to discuss their motivation and ambitions. Growth opportunities can be both horizontal and

vertical. Examples of growth opportunities are: expanding the scope within a team member's current role, a lateral move to a new role, or a promotion to the next level.

- Compensation: At GitLab, compensation = cash + equity + benefits. We have a market-based approach and differentiate pay based on performance. Our Annual Compensation Review Cycle and Annual Equity Refresh program allow us to differentiate compensation based on performance and for Key Talent.

- Succession Planning: As team members identified as Key Talent are critical to roles that have a high impact on the company's success, it is important that we identify successors to mitigate risk in the organization.

Note that being considered or designated as a key talent one year, does not mean or guarantee that a team member will be considered or designated as a key talent moving forward.

Key Talent Program

Supporting Key Talent at GitLab is a critical element of business scalability and organizational development and growth. Our Key Talent are often individuals that can be looked to for mentorship and guidance by others, but it is also important that we invest in the development of this group and ensure that key knowledge is shared. A couple of key ways we can support our Key Talent is through regular discussions and the development of Individual Growth Plans (IGPs).

Below are suggestions for getting started, resources for managers, a Key Talent Engagement Discussion template, and a recommended cadence.

Key Talent Engagement Discussion

One way to set up a structure and regular cadence for touchpoints with our Key Talent population is through Key Talent Engagement Discussions. We recommended these discussion focus areas are: Overall Engagement, Growth/Challenge, and Support Needed. The main goals for check-ins with this group include:

1. Get a pulse on overall engagement
1. Uncover potential risks for business continuity and implement plans to mitigate
1. Identify areas of support needed
1. Identify opportunity for stretch projects and continued growth
1. Use this discussion as a starting point to partner with team members to get Individual Growth Plans (IGPs) in place
1. Leverage this data to identify key themes and potential actions across our Key Talent pool with the goal of improving engagement (leaders can work with their aligned People Business Partner on this piece)

Managers can leverage this template to help facilitate consistency in Key Talent Engagement Discussions.

Individual Growth Plans (IGPs)

Key Talent Engagement Discussions can be a great starting point to start thinking through Individual Growth Plans, which is the recommended next step. Some ideas for our Key Talent population to consider when thinking through Individual Growth Plans (IGPs) include:

- Stretch project (Cross functional, and an opportunity to be DRI)
- Mentor (leader to help identify internal or external mentor)
- Coach or Coaching program (e.g. Coaching Right Now)
- Management development (if applicable)
- Cross-functional/leadership exposure plan
- Cross learning plan with other roles within their division

Cadence

We recommend that managers perform Key Talent Engagement Discussions twice per year, roughly every 5-6 months. Discussion timing is at manager discretion, as we want to ensure these discussions are held at the most relevant and impactful time for each team member. Key Talent Engagement Discussions are more geared towards stay interview format, and should not replace ongoing informal check-ins, regular feedback, and growth discussions that happen more regularly in 1:1s.

A couple of options for Key Talent Engagement Discussions that managers can consider are:

1. Before Mid-Year check-in: Before our company-wide Mid-Year check-ins. This cadence would be 1) Key Talent Engagement Discussions, 2) Mid year check-in discussion, 3) Individual Growth Plans (IGPs) (if applicable). Touching base with Key Talent ahead of Mid-year check-ins can help provide an insightful baseline and level of insight before going into more performance-focused discussions.

In FY'24 Q2, we will begin optional Key Talent Engagement Discussions across the organization aligned with our upcoming mid-year check-in process. For divisions or departments that choose to opt in, the high level timeline would be as follows (exact dates TBD):

- May: Key Talent Engagement Discussions (optional)
- June: Mid year check-ins (required)
- July: IGP (Individual Growth Plan) development (optional)

1. After our Talent Assessment cycle: This cadence would be 1) Self-assessment, 2) Talent Assessment performance review discussion, 3) Key Talent Engagement Discussion, 4) Individual Growth Plans (IGPs) (if applicable). We recommend that Key Talent Engagement Discussions occur after Talent Assessments as opposed to before to ensure we have the most recent group of key talent calibrated and confirmed before Key Talent Engagement Discussions occur.

As mentioned above, Key Talent Engagement Discussions can be done at any point during the year, it is not necessary that they are coupled with our Mid year check-in process.

SECTION: people-group/talent-development-program.md

Why a Talent Development Program is vital for GitLab

As we continue to scale, we want to be intentional about Talent Development. Investing in a Talent Development Program creates the opportunity for GitLab to build diverse, flexible and versatile teams, as well as of the utmost importance to ongoing success across all teams.

GitLab's Talent Development Program includes the following initiatives:

- Talent Assessment Tool
- 360 Feedback
- Organisational Structure and gaps
- Performance Assessments and Succession Planning
- Career Development Conversations
- Performance Improvement Plans (PIP)
- Performance Enablement Review
- Individual Growth Plan
- Engagement Survey
- Annual Compensation Review

Talent Development Program Chart

mermaid

graph LR

Aid1([Talent
 Assessment Tool]):::classA --> Eid1([Succession
 Planning]):::classB

Bid1([Org Structure
 & Gaps]):::classA --> Eid1([Succession
 Planning]):::classB

Cid1([Critical
 Roles]):::classA --> Eid1([Succession
 Planning]):::classB

Did1([360
 Feedback]):::classA --> Eid1([Succession
 Planning]):::classB

Eid1([Succession
 Planning]):::classB --> Fid1([Assess Hiring
 Implications & Requirements]):::classC

Eid1([Succession
 Planning]):::classB --> Gid1([Career Development
 Conversations]):::classC

Gid1([Career Development
 Conversations]):::classC --> Hid1([Individual
 Growth Plan]):::classD

Gid1([Career Development
 Conversations]):::classC --> Iid1([Performance
 Enablement Plan]):::classD

Gid1([Career Development
 Conversations]):::classC --> Jid1([Performance
 Improvement Plan]):::classD

click Aid1 "/handbook/people-group/talent-assessment"

click Bid1 "/handbook/company/structure/"

click Did1 "360-feedback"

click Eid1 "/handbook/people-group/talent-assessment"

click Fid1 "/handbook/hiring/"

click Gid1 "1-1"

click Hid1 "/handbook/people-group/learning-and-development/career-developmentinternal-resources"

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We are using this Talent Development Program issue to work on the content and overall planning of this page and the program. Follow along and please contribute!

SECTION: people-group/team-member-relations.md

Team Member Relations

The Team Member Relations team is responsible for facilitating and resolving all people matter related team member issues. They will also assist in creating and informing team members of policies that are fair and consistent for all GitLab team members. As part of the People group the Team Member Relations team works with both the manager and team member in an intermediary function to understand and help resolve workplace issues. The Team Member Relations team can also help coach and advise managers and team members on policies and processes.

Team member relation issues can range from simple coaching questions to serious code of conduct violations. We classify these different level of team member cases by tiers. Example of issues/cases by tier level:

Tier 1

- Coaching support
- Performance Management
- Unprofessional behavior
- Relocation concerns
- Absenteeism

Tier 2

- Job abandonment
- Manager/team member conflict resolution
- Team member/team member conflict resolution

Tier 3

- Ethic Violations
- Harrassment
- Retaliation
- Any Code of Conduct Violation

All Tier 3 cases will be managed together with Legal and the TMR team.

Discussing Private Concerns

Team members who would like to discuss a private matter should send an email requesting support from our Team Member Relations team to teammemberrelations@gitlab.com. Please include the following in your email:

- Subject Line should be "New Request for assistance"
- Name of Team member requesting support (Name of the person sending the email)
- Name of Team member(s) involved in the matter
- Team members location (example Orlando, Florida or Berlin, Germany) for managers who are

requesting support regarding a team member issue on their team please use the location of the team member and not your location.

- Tier level as listed above
- Job title of team member requesting support
- Division
- Department
- Brief description of type support needed. Example - I am looking for guidance for managing a team members' performance.

The Team Member Relations team will reach out within 24 hours from when the request was sent via email during the business week.

GitLab also offers a Harassment Complaint Form that any team member may use to document any instance of any type of workplace harassment. Simply copy the form, fill it out with your information and send it to our Team Member Relations Specialist at teammemberrelations@gitlab.com.

Team members and the TMR should both respond to questions or queries via slack or email within 24 hours to continue making progress on the issue and get to a timely resolution.

For urgent requests that need immediate attention please ask for urgent assistance by sending a message marked URGENT to teammemberrelations@gitlab.com. If you do not receive support in a timely manner, below is the escalation path:

- Vice President of People Operations, Technology and Analytics
- Chief People Officer

An urgent request would be something that needs immediate attention like team members safety or a code of conduct violation.

Raising Communication Concerns

1. We ask all GitLab team members to follow our Effective & Responsible Communication Guidelines.

- These guidelines highlight the expectation that everyone assumes positive intent, exercises kindness, and expresses your thoughts responsibly and inclusively.

2. If there is an issue to raise regarding someone's communication or conduct, team members should raise their concern with the manager of the individual involved or, if preferred, email Team Member Relations (teammemberrelations@gitlab.com) directly.

3. Managers can email Team Member Relations (teammemberrelations@gitlab.com) to express concerns with a team member's communication if they believe intervention is needed.

- If a team member is in violation of the effective & responsible communication guidelines, the Team Member Relations team will reach out to the manager and disciplinary action could be taken.

Team Member Relations Philosophy

GitLab believes in preserving the dignity of each team member and expects everyone to treat others with fairness, respect, and transparency. We encourage mutual responsibility for constructive work relationships and communication, information sharing, problem solving and a

safe neutral process through which differences can be resolved. Direct and honest communication is strongly encouraged between all team members regardless of title or level and per our values we do not pull rank. Such communication is likely to enhance understanding, avoid misunderstandings and create rapid solutions to concerns.

We have built this philosophy to focus on these 4 pillars in line with our values:

- Collaboration
- Diversity, Inclusion & Belonging
- Results
- Transparency

Commitments

- We are committed to providing a safe environment for all GitLab team members to achieve maximum career development and goal achievement.
- We are committed to treating each team member as an individual and providing a workplace where communication is transparent and where problems can be discussed and resolved in a mutually respectful environment. To foster this environment we take into account individual team member circumstances and the individual team member while balancing the needs of the business.

Team Member Relations Function

To support our team members, GitLab has established a Team member relations group to assist team members and their leaders with resolving work related issues. The Team Member Relations team (TMR) respects the privacy of all team members and treats discussions with the fullest degree of confidentiality possible. We have incorporated our Values and the Code of Business Conduct and Ethics into our team member relations practices and philosophy. We believe that by communicating with each other directly and transparently, we can continue to resolve any difficulties that may arise and continue to make GitLab a great place to work.

For Team Members

The team member relations function provides all GitLab team members an avenue to express workplace concerns and to resolve conflicts in a safe and unbiased forum.

- Team members can express themselves openly and freely without fear of retaliation.
- Professional behavior and conduct is expected from all team members. As a reminder use judgement in your conversations with other team members. We encourage all team members to provide direct feedback to each other. The team member relations group is here to listen to team members concerns in an unbiased, open and professional manner.
- Team members can discuss reasonable accommodations or any related questions.

For Managers

Team member relations provides guidance to managers in their efforts to improve team member performance or to correct unacceptable personal behaviors. Managers are responsible for setting priorities and motivating their team members. They are also responsible for ensuring the care of their team members as well as meeting GitLab's goals. These two things can be done

simultaneously. As managers it is considered one of your primary responsibilities to understand GitLab's Code of Business Conduct and Ethics, Values and People Group policies and processes. People managers are responsible for upholding compliance on their teams and considering the best interest of the business. If a manager is made aware of a situation that potentially runs afoul of the Code of Conduct, Values and People Group processes or policy they should immediately reach out to the team member relations specialist. If uncertain about a specific policy or procedure, the manager should reach out to a leader, their aligned PBP or the Team member relation specialist for further clarification. When in doubt, it is always best to ask.

Team Member Performance Improvement Management Guiding Principles

A critical responsibility within the role of a GitLab leader is to spend the time required to truly understand the causes of the performance issue and how to address them properly. GitLab managers will determine if the performance concerns are skill-based or behavior (will)-based to determine next steps. Below are the definitions of both skill- and will-based performance concerns.

Skill-based performance management

- Team member lacks the technical knowledge or capability to be successful in the role
- Team member is unable to prioritize work effectively
- Team member lacks the understanding on how to complete tasks
- Team member exhibits difficulties working with team members and/or communicating effectively

Sometimes skill-based issues appear as a will-based or behavior concern. However, after delving into the cause for the behavior, the leader may find a skill-based gap causing the disruptive behavior. The team member may be embarrassed or concerned about their ineffectiveness or ability to perform their role and may react in a way that is inappropriate.

The following are a few recommendations for a manager to address skill-based performance issues:

- Provide the team member with additional training
- Provide the team member with a mentor or buddy
- Provide the team member with clear directions and examples

If the team member is still not making progress after the manager has provided additional resources or coaching please review the underperformance page in the handbook for next steps.

Will-based performance management

Will-based issues are described as undesirable behavior that impedes the success of the Team Member, the Team, and/or GitLab as a whole. The leader may hear about the behaviors from others or experience the undesirable behavior directly. It is important that the manager address the concerns right away. While "will" issues can be disruptive, there are different levels of severity which must be considered when determining next steps. The tiers below are examples and are not exhaustive, and should be used for comparison purposes to determine the impact to GitLab.

Tier 2 - Misconduct resulting in limited material risk to GitLab

- Violations of the company code of conduct (excluding harassment and discrimination)
- Team member uses inappropriate language that others may find offensive
- Team members behavior creates a negative or toxic team environment
- Behavior continues even after coaching from manager

For Tier 2 level concerns, the Manager should reach out and discuss with the team member relations specialist immediately.

Tier 1 - Gross misconduct or a violation with serious implications to GitLab.

- Violates a law/regulation (theft, fraud, drug use, etc.)
- Poses a serious operational, reputational, or financial risk to GitLab
- Poses significant health or safety risks
- Harassment
- Severe and/or pervasive language or conduct that could be perceived as discriminatory or creating a hostile work environment

Since situations differ, managers should immediately reach out to a team member relations specialist for guidance before taking any action. If unable to contact the team member relations specialist directly, please follow the escalation path listed in the handbook

Please review the underperformance page in the handbook for further information regarding managing team member performance.

SECTION: people-group/tech-stack-guide-workday.md

People Group Tech Stack Guide

> Note: Refer to the Tech Stack Index to browse Apps and Tech Stack Applications to manage Apps.

{{% tech-stack "Workday" %}}

Implementation

Workday is being implemented in 3 phases:

Phase 1 (completed)

Go live date: 2022-06-16

Modules/functionality being implemented:

- Human Capital Management (core team member information)
- Job change workflows and processes (onboarding, offboarding, job changes)
- Core Compensation

- Integrations with other applications across GitLab

| Workday will replace | Workday will enhance | Workday will integrate with | What remains the same in this phase |

| ----- | ----- | ----- | ----- |

| BambooHR (with a few exceptions to certain business processes) | Reporting, Auditing, Organization hierarchy, Management hierarchy, Business process workflows | Greenhouse, Culture Amp, Navan Expense, LawLogix, Modern Health, Navex, Netsuite, E-trade, ADP, Okta, Nominator bot, People Connect bot, Employment Automations | Time Off by Deel, Documents, Contractor Invoices |

- BambooHR is no longer in use at GitLab as of 2024-12-15.

> Details of each integration including frequency can be found in the Workday Guide

Phase 2

Go live date for: 2022-10-14 (in progress)

Modules/functionality being implemented:

- Talent Optimization

Go live date for: 2023-01-06 (in progress)

Modules/functionality being implemented:

- Benefits - US Only
- Absence Management
- Advanced Compensation
- Integrations

| Workday will replace |

| ----- |

| Talent Assessment Tool, Compaas (Compensation planning tool), PlanSource, Internal Employment Automations |

Phase 3

Go live date: To be determined

Modules/functionality being implemented:

- Continuation of absence management plans

Sys